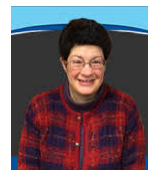




1

Who is Liz Weintraub?

- A self advocate
- An advocate with a disability
- A wife
- A daughter
- A sister
- A friend



2

Who is Rylin Rodgers?

Leader

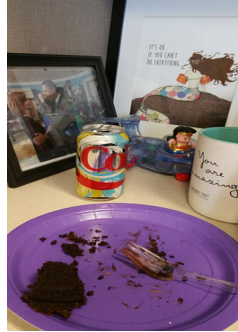
- Director of Public Policy, Association of University Centers on Disabilities (AUCD)
- Former Training Director, Family Leadership Coordinator, Riley Child Development Center (LEND)
- Former State Coordinator, Director, Family Voices Indiana

Family

- Mom to Matthew (22, working) and Laura (19, Sophomore in College)

Self

- Person with Disability (Dyslexic)



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Who you ARE



Agents of Change

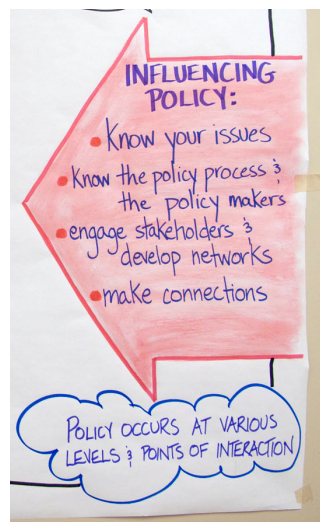


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Why Your Voice is Needed

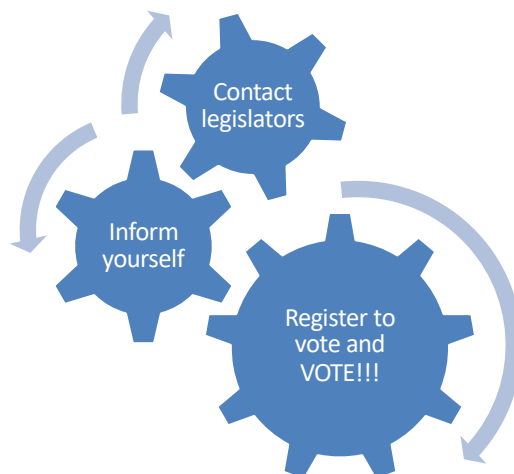
- You have **expertise** and passion
- Your **work** and **life** will be **impacted** by policymakers' decisions
- You **vote** and can hold policymakers accountable
- If you don't **speak up**, someone else will **speak for you**



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Things to Do...



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Political context

- Divided Congress
 - Democratic Control of House
 - Narrow Republican Control in Senate
- Very partisan and divided
- Unconventional Presidential Administration
 - Impeachment
- Race for 2020
 - Slows things down; votes are tied to campaigns



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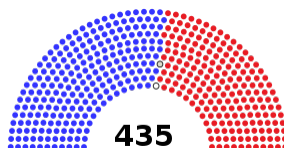
7

U.S. Congress – 116th Congress

House

235 Democrats
197 Republicans
1 Independent

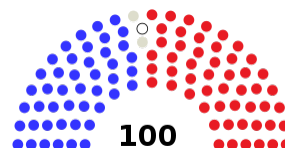
2 Vacant



Senate

45 Democrats
52 Republicans

2 Independents
1 Vacant



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MUST KNOW

- President
- Governor
- **Both Senators**
- **Your Representative**
- You State Rep and Senator

GOOD TO KNOW

- Relevant Cabinet Secretary
- Leaders in State House
- School Board
- Who is running for all the seats...



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BE INFORMED

- ✓ Know Your Members
 - Follow what they do
- ✓ Know the Issues
 - Follow the bills
- ✓ Know the Funding
 - Follow the budget





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Hot Topics 116th Congress

Education

- Higher Education Act
 - Senate Action
 - House Action

Employment

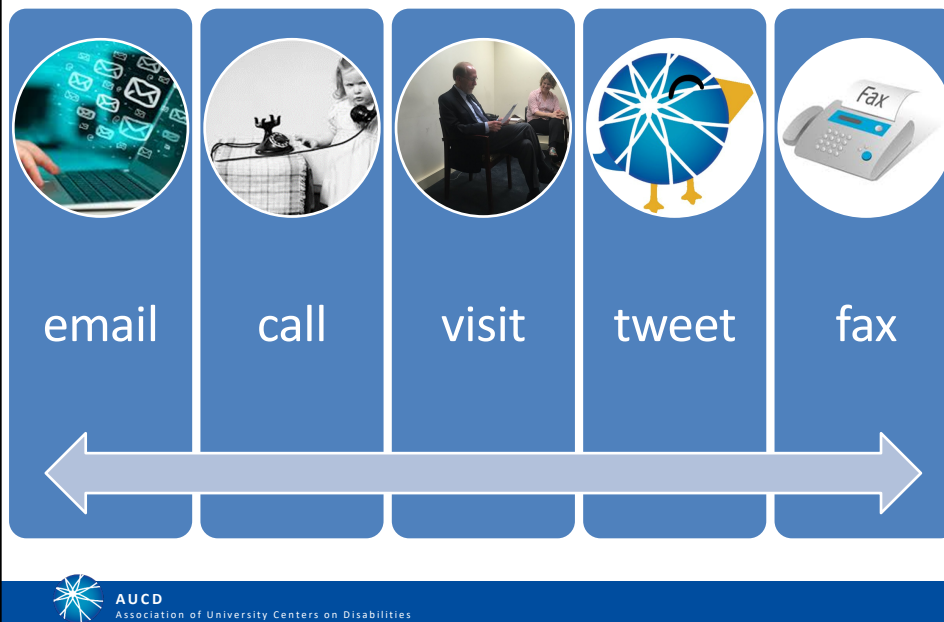
- Transformation to Competitive Employment Act
 - H.R.873
 - 46 Democrats
 - 6 Republicans
 - S.260
 - 6 Democrats
 - 1 Independent
 - Possible Republicans?



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Relationships Make the Difference

- Members Matter
- Staff Matter
 - Know the Legislative correspondent and Legislative Assistant that work on your issues for each member of your congressional Delegation
- Be a resource
 - Update on how policy is impacting you
 - Share data
 - Share research
 - Invite to district events
- Thank and congratulate around success



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VOTE 2020

1

President

All 435 seats in the United States House of Representatives

35 of the 100 seats in the United States Senate will be contested.

2

35.4 million people with disabilities are eligible to vote

- this number increases to 62.7 million eligible voters
- 25% of the total electorate, when we include family members

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Favorite Resources



- From AUCD, *Tuesdays with Liz: Disability Policy for All*, a weekly video series highlighting current issues in disability policy and *Disability Policy News In Brief*, a weekly policy digest delivered on Mondays www.aucd.org



- *Wake Up to Politics*, non-partisan daily digest written by 15-year old Gabe Fleisher
<https://www.wakeuptopolitics.com>



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More Favorite Resources!

Two groups hosted by Think College



- *Emerging Advocates*, hosted by Liz: anyone interested in learning about the importance of advocacy and how to advocate is welcome, though it is intended for students & people with disabilities
<https://thinkcollege.net/technical-assistance/affinity-groups/advocates>



- *Public Policy*, hosted by Denise Rozell: this group is for those interested in learning about public policy that affects people with disabilities, particularly in relation to education, employment, and independent living
<https://thinkcollege.net/technical-assistance/affinity-groups/public-policy>



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Questions?

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